

## **Decoy Painting**

**Grades:**       Preschool, Primary, and Middle

**Time :**        40 - 60 Minutes

**Objectives:**   From participation in this activity, students will:

- (Science)       > Identify at least 3 species of waterfowl
- (Science)       > Demonstrate an understanding of waterfowl anatomy
- (Science)       > Distinguish between different types of plumage and its purpose
- (Science)       > Distinguish between male and female species, and 2 characteristics of each
- (Science)       > Identify natural habitat, nesting areas, and food sources
- (Art)            > Create a replica of some specie of waterfowl an show an understanding of color, detail, and texture
- (Art)            > Demonstrate basic hand-eye coordination through the painting process
- > Demonstrate abilities in listening and following directions throughout painting and clean-up processes

**Materials:**

duck blanks (resin and wood base)  
acrylic paint  
water  
pictures of different species of waterfowl (preferably male and female)  
cups  
paper and plastic plates  
brushes  
paper towels  
books pertaining to waterfowl on their age level (optional)

**Instructions:**

- 1) Give a general introduction to vast variety of waterfowl species (include species they will be painting in this activity.) Show pictures of drakes and hens in as many species as time frame allows. Discuss importance of habitat, food sources, plumage, migratory patterns, and nesting areas.
- 2) Distribute blank replicas of waterfowl to be painted. Place each duck on a paper plate. Explain this will become their creation. Students will be given a plastic plate to be used as their paint palette, one for every two children. This encourages partnership, cooperation, responsibility, and a sense of sharing.
- 3) Explain not to begin painting until all directions are given.  
First ask each student to write their name and date on the bottom of each duck.



Encourage students to paint the head of their duck last, use it as a handle in painting process).

Explain to always clean brushes thoroughly when changing colors using cups of water and dot brushes dry on paper towels.

Use larger brushes for base coats and large blocks of color.

Use smaller brushes for adding detail.

The back end of the brushes work well in painting eyes and dots.

Encourage students to always place brushes in water cups to prevent drying out.

As students finish their work, each specimen on a small paper plate for drying.

4) On each paint palette (plastic plate) place variety of colors (small portions- they can always get more) for painting their waterfowl. Allow students to begin creating. Try to allow for creativity and/or accuracy depending on age level and coordination abilities.

**Options:** 1) As students begin to complete their projects, (some will move faster than others), encourage quicker students to read about different species and search for one unusual fact they did not know to share with their fellow students.

2) When most students have finished their project, gather group for reading a particular story about waterfowl.

**Evaluation:** Are students able to answer oral follow-up questions concerning specie identification, plumage, migratory patterns, and habitat? Do their painting projects reflect knowledge of colors and camouflage of particular species? Have students cleaned their work areas and left supplies in a neat orderly fashion? Do students relate interesting and pertinent facts from their reading time?